

Samsung to close its sole China TV factory by November

According to a report, Samsung has decided to stop production at its only TV factory in China by the end of November. This is the latest development in a series of moves by the South Korean firm to shift production from the world's second-largest economy. An official spokesman shared that the TV factory in Tianjin is the only Samsung TV production base in China. This decision is part of "ongoing efforts to enhance efficiency" in its production facilities. As per reports, the factory has about 300 workers, and some of the workers and equipment are expected to be retained.

Silicon Labs and Amazon collaborate for shared network Sidewalk

Silicon Labs has announced a collaboration with Amazon to support Amazon Sidewalk, a shared network created by neighbours who share a small portion of Wi-Fi bandwidth to help their devices work better at home and beyond the front door. Silicon Labs' wireless solutions for Amazon Sidewalk will enable developers to create IoT products with encrypted cloud communication, no matter which protocol is used. Silicon Labs' EFR Wireless Gecko Series products support Sidewalk's sub-GHz and Bluetooth Low Energy protocols.

TT Electronics and iAbra launch AI-driven Covid-19 test

TT Electronics, a global provider of engineered electronics for performance-critical applications, has announced that it has been working with British startup iAbra and its partners, including Intel, to design, develop and test the prototype Virolens system and to specify and design the manufacturing processes for its commercial launch. The Virolens system, which provides test results for Covid-19 in twenty seconds, has been launched after successful trials at London Heathrow Airport. The Virolens Covid-19 screening device uses microscopic holographic imaging and artificial intelligence (AI) software technology to detect the presence of the virus from a non-intrusive saliva swab test within twenty seconds.

Mouser Electronics announces global deal with BittWare

Mouser Electronics has announced a global distribution agreement with BittWare, a Molex company. Through the agreement, Mouser now stocks high-end card-level solutions from BittWare, based on FPGA technology from Intel and Xilinx. BittWare's XUP-VV8 FPGA accelerator card integrates a Xilinx Virtex UltraScale+ VU13P FPGA in a 3/4-length PCIe board with large logic resources up to 3.8M logic cells as well as 455 Mbits of embedded memory. The card is available in air- or liquid-cooled options and includes four QSFP-DD (double-density) cages for maximum port density.

China. I am glad to inform that Apple is shifting to India in a significant way, Samsung has already come, and they further want to expand. I have been told that around eight factories of Apple have shifted to India from China."

He also added that when their BJP government had come to power in 2014, there were only two mobile factories in the country, but now the number has crossed 250. Presently, the government has launched Atmanirbhar Bharat with a production linked incentive. They have invited global companies to come to India to explore the opportunities here.

TN government unveils new policy for electronics and hardware manufacturing

According to a report, the Tamil Nadu government has announced a new electronics and hardware manufacturing policy to increase the state's electronics industry output to 100 billion dollars by 2025. The state hopes to contribute 25 per cent of India's total electronic exports to the world by 2025.

The policy also undertakes skill training for more than 100,000 people (semi-skilled and skilled) by 2024. This would help meet the incremental human resource requirement project-

ed by the NSDC for Tamil Nadu in the electronics and hardware manufacturing sector.

It also targets to increase the level of value addition that is done in Tamil Nadu, especially across focus sectors such as mobile handsets, LED products, chip designs, PCBs, solar photovoltaic cells, medical electronics, and automotive electronics.

All incentives offered by the state government to units in the electronics manufacturing industry shall be in addition to the incentives offered by the government of India to those units. Investments made from January 1, 2020, will be considered eligible for availing incentives.

Scientists in Europe find a simple way to extract lithium

Researchers at Karlsruhe Institute of Technology (KIT) in Germany have developed a simple and environment-friendly process to extract lithium from the salty thermal water reservoirs that are located in river Rhine's upper trench, according to *mining.com*. Lithium is in a great demand for producing batteries that are used to power smartphones, laptops, cameras, and now electric vehicles in large quantities.

The process developed at KIT involves simply filtering out lithium ions from the thermal water and con-

centrating the ions until lithium can be obtained as a salt. There can be as much as 200 milligrams of lithium ions in one litre of water. The process does not require a very large infrastructure in the form of a landmass. And since the water goes back to the river after use, it can be reused for other applications as before.

At present, Germany imports lithium mostly from Chile, Argentina and Australia, which it uses largely for the production of battery cells that are required for electric vehicles being produced in the country. This process could also prove very valuable for climate protection programme being followed very actively in Germany.

A similar process is also being tried in the United Kingdom by Geothermal Engineering with the help of Cornish Lithium in Cornwall. They plan to draw water from their deep geothermal well and process it to extract lithium using Direct Lithium Extraction (DLE), which essentially 'sieves' lithium from the water. The water can then be released back into the ground using bore-wells.

This process could be a great boon for many countries, including India, if suitable lithium-rich water can be located for extraction. Until now, China was considered to be the main source for lithium import in India.